REP-089 · Playtest feedback: seven reports checked

Game	Fruit Market 1.8.0 live (rules version 9). No game code changed by this report.
Report date	2026-11-08 (Asia/Kuala_Lumpur)
Type	Investigation of playtest feedback
Request	"investigate below feedback" (seven reports: Closing Day $0 or $1, "Enough buyers for everyone", "too old" when the price was too high, Juice Bar warnings, Juice Bar salvage profit, advice that ignores Rosa's tie win, Scout labelled Gossip and "unripe $1 now")
Status	Waiting for your choices (section 1). Nothing is fixed yet.

1. What I need from you

1. **Fix package A** (wording and explanations, section 4): may I fix it? It changes no rule, price or balance, and saves and online play keep working. It does edit the wording of RULES.md and How to play, which are preserved files, so it needs your yes. **Recommended: yes.**
2. **Juice Bar money trick** (item 5): (C) keep it and explain it on the card (**recommended**), (A) juice pays $1 instead of $2, or (B) only fruit you already had before today can become juice. A and B are rules changes (rules version 10).
3. **Computer players** (package B): should they also learn that Closing Day leftovers are worth $1, and the real tie order? This changes how strong they play, so it needs a balance run first. **Recommended: yes, as a second step after A.**

If you say yes to A without more detail, I will assume: the Closing Day rule stays as approved in REP-032 and REP-033 (the jam maker pays $1 for each leftover ripe fruit); the Scout and Gossip badge gets one neutral line ("You've seen this walk-in's card") rather than two labels; green watermelons are retired in the rulebook and How to play, and their always-empty $1 slot is hidden on the market (the engine is not touched).

2. The short version

All seven reports are correct. None of them is a broken rule in the engine: the game does what RULES.md says. What is wrong is what the game *tells* the player, plus one rule that allows a sure profit.

#	Tester's report	What is actually wrong	Kind
1	Closing Day says $0, but I got $2	The game pays $1 per leftover ripe fruit (the approved rule). The morning card, the shelf chip, the end-of-game recap, the rulebook's Goal line and How to play still say $0 or "worth nothing". The Stocking note says $1 even when Closing Day is switched off. The final day's sales card leaves the jam money out.	Text bug, plus 2 logic bugs
2	"Enough buyers for	The line counts every order for that fruit, including buyers who will not take your freshness or your price.	Logic bug

#	Tester's report	What is actually wrong	Kind
	everyone" was wrong		
3	Fresh fruit called "too old"	One flag covers three causes: price above the customer's top, customer type (Premium buys fresh only, Everyday never buys tired) and real age. The explanation always says "too old". The same mix-up makes false lines such as "Rosa edged you out", "undercut you on a $0 sale" and "You beat Rosa".	Logic bug in the explanations
4	Juice Bar warnings	The warnings say the fruit will spoil, but a Juice Bar turns up to 3 pieces into $2 of juice. The money is shown nowhere. The same warnings also ignore Heatwave (more fruit spoils) and Cold Room (nothing spoils on odd nights). The "Juice Bar Regular" achievement does not count juice money.	Logic bug
5	Buy 3 tired blueberries for $3, get $6	True, and the rules allow it: +3*anight*, *guaranteed*.*Mostaplayercanmake* : *about*+18 in a 10-day game. Typical chance in a normal game: $4 to $8. Computer players gain about $1 to $2 a game from it.	Rules or balance question
6	Advice ignores that Rosa wins ties	After the bell, "At $6 you'd have sold 2" never says a tie at $7 loses to the Haggler. In other cases it tells you to go $1 lower than needed, counts the same fruit twice for two buyers, or tells you to cut your price when you sold out anyway. The tie reason is wrong when both stalls played Favoured Trade. The pre-filled price assumes a tie splits the sale.	Logic bug (and balance, for the computers)
7	Scout shown as Gossip; "unripe $1 now"	Scout and Gossip mark a card in the same way, and the badge always says Gossip. The set-up text dates from when green fruit cost $1. Today only mangoes arrive green, at $4. The market still shows an empty green watermelon slot priced $1.	Text bug, plus a small rules tidy-up

3. Each item

Every item was reproduced on the real game engine with test scripts, then checked a second time by an independent review. Corrections from that review are included below.

3.1 Closing Day: $0 or $1

- **What happens.** Final day, Closing Day on (the default). The morning card says "Anything unsold tonight is worth $0. Sell it all!" and the shelf chip says "Unsold = $0". The Stocking panel says the jam maker pays $1. The engine pays $1 for each leftover ripe fruit. Tester's case reproduced exactly: 2 stalls, seed 2, two ripe leftovers, cash $95 → $97. Over 360 test games the payout always equalled $1 × ripe leftovers with Closing Day on, and $0 with it off.
- **Why.** The $0 lines only check "is this the last day", never "is Closing Day on". They were written before Closing Day existed (rules 4) and were never updated. The end-of-game recap counts the fruit the jam maker bought as "worth $0" and also mixes in green fruit, which the jam maker does not buy. RULES.md line 33, How to play and GAME-BRIEF say "worth nothing", which contradicts RULES.md line 122.
- **Two more bugs found.** (a) The Stocking note promises $1 even when Closing Day is switched off, and says "anything left" although green fruit gets nothing. (b) The final "Market closed" sales card is drawn before the jam payout, so its ledger leaves the money out. The only place the $2 is explained is one line on the results screen. That is why it felt like a surprise.

- **Fix (package A).** One shared sentence used by the morning card, shelf chip and Stocking note: "Ripe fruit left tonight goes to the jam maker for $1 each" when Closing Day is on; "$0" when it is off or only green fruit is left. Recap: "2 ripe fruit left at closing: the jam maker paid $2." Add the jam line to the final sales card. Fix the rulebook, How to play and brief wording. No rules change.
- **Computer players (package B).** On the final day the price helper and the computer players treat a leftover as worth $0 instead of $1, so they cut prices slightly more than they should (108 of 750 price decisions change at Normal level, 229 of 746 at Hard). This affects balance, so it needs a balance run. The jam maker cannot be farmed: fruit never costs less than $1, so buying fruit just to sell it to the jam maker breaks even at best.

3.2 "Enough buyers for everyone"

- **What happens.** You have 2 okay mangoes out. Bobby Books (Everyday) wants 1 and Captain Ahmad (Premium, fresh only) wants 5. Rivals have 3 fresh out. The panel says "Enough buyers for everyone (5 out for 6)". Only Bobby can buy your fruit, and you sell 1 of 2 at any price. The buyer chips on the same card already show Ahmad in red, so the card contradicts itself. A second case: okay mangoes priced $1 above an Everyday buyer's okay limit also get "Enough buyers" and sell 0.
- **Why.** The line adds up every order for the fruit and ignores freshness type and the price cap.
- **Fix (package A).** Walk through today's buyers in serving order against a copy of your shelf, the same way the engine sells, and say "Enough buyers" only if all your pieces could sell. Otherwise: "Only 1 of your 2 would sell at $7 (freshness or price)", or "Nobody takes yours at $8". The open-your-stall card's "N wanted today" gets the same treatment. The market-wide demand bar has the same blind spot but matters less; its legend can say "enough orders".

3.3 "Too old" when the price was too high

- **What happens.** Fresh apples at $5 for Inspector Wei, whose top is $4. The game says "Your apples were too old for Inspector Wei at $5." Fresh fruit could not sell at $5 either. Other wrong cases: okay apples at $1 for Premium Ravi ("too old", with a hint that okay fruit sells for $1 less, which is false for Premium); tired apples at $1 for Everyday Tan; a Premium Display stall told the wrong top.
- **Why.** The engine records one yes/no flag for "nothing qualified", and the explanation always turns it into "too old". The sale result itself is correct.
- **Knock-on bugs.** The same flag makes false end-of-day lines ("Rosa edged you out by $1 or less"; "You beat Rosa to a customer!" when Rosa's price was over the top), a false recap line ("Rosa undercut you by $1 on a $0 sale", "Rosa took 2 customers from you"), a false tie headline, rival taunts about a sale that was never contested, and "You offer 0" on the Showdown card.
- **Fix (package A), explanation only.** Name the real reason: over the top ("$5 is more than Inspector Wei pays for apples: $4 at most, even fresh"), fresh only (Premium), won't take tired (Everyday), or too old. This rule was tested on 107,133 random cases and always matched the true cause. Offers that did not qualify are left out of every "beat", "undercut" and "tie" line.

3.4 Juice Bar warnings

- **What happens.** A Juice Bar stall holds 3 tired blueberries. The sales card says "3 fruit on its last day spoils tonight", the day highlight says "3 of your fruit will spoil tonight", and the night animation shows them rotting. Next morning cash is $6 higher and nothing explains why: the morning card reports only spoiled fruit, and the $6 is already inside the next day's starting cash.
- **More of the same.** The forecast ignores Heatwave (3 okay berries: no warning, then "3 spoiled overnight") and Cold Room (warns on odd nights when nothing spoils). The "Juice Bar Regular" achievement ("earn $20 from your Juice Bar") only counts the +$1 sale tip, not the juice money: a stall paid $42 of juice did not get it.
- **Fix (package A).** One "tonight" forecast that follows the real night rules (Cold Room, Heatwave, Juice Bar): "2 spoil tonight, 3 become juice (+$6)". Morning line: "Your Juice Bar made $6 from 3 fruit overnight." Show juiced pieces as juice in the animation. Add an optional juice counter to each player's stats for the achievement and the results screen (old saves still load; it is never read by the rules).

3.5 Juice Bar salvage profit

- **What happens.** Confirmed. Buy 3 tired blueberries at $1 each, put nothing out, and the Juice Bar pays 6*thatnight* : +3, whatever the customers do. It can start on the night you build the Juice Bar (the 3*buildpaysforitselfthatnight*).*Limits* : 3*piecesanight*; *break* – *evenonaPriceHikeday*(2 tired fruit); nothing on Cold Room odd nights; no night after Closing Day. It costs 3 of your 6 daily buys and needs tired fruit in the market.
- **Size.** Most a player can make: about +18*netina*10 – *daygame*(+12 in 8 days, +$30 in 14). Typical natural chance with Normal opponents: about $4 to $8 a game before the build cost. Normal and Hard computer players already use it a little (about $6 to $7 of juice a game); the trick itself adds about $1 to $2, which does not move win rates.
- **Context.** REP-086 found the Juice Bar and Cold Room nearly useless because computers rarely lose fruit to rot. The studio economy audit listed this loop as an untested idea (07-ECONOMY-BALANCE E8). No decision has accepted or rejected it.
- **Options.**
  - **C · Keep it and explain it (recommended).** It is a small, skill-based trick that gives a weak upgrade a job, and it is easy to follow on a table. Card tip: "Last-day fruit bought for $1 becomes $2 of juice." No rules change.
  - **A · Juice pays $1.** Saves waste, no profit on $1 fruit. Makes the Juice Bar even weaker. Rules version 10 and a balance run.
  - **B · Only fruit on your shelf before today's buying can become juice.** Keeps $2 but needs the engine and the table to track which fruit was bought today, which is fiddly on a table. Rules version 10 and a balance run.

3.6 Advice that ignores Rosa's tie win

- **What happens.** Rosa (Haggler) posts $7, you post $8, both fresh. The game says "Rosa undercut you by $1 and stole the sale! … At $6 you'd have sold 2." The number is right (a $7 tie loses to the Haggler), but the reason is missing, so it reads like "always undercut by $1". The same gap appears when Rosa played Favoured Trade.
- **More cases where the advice is wrong.** (a) Benny (not a Haggler) at $7 with okay fruit, you at $8 with fresh: the advice says $6, but matching $7 also sells 2 (fresher fruit wins the tie) and earns $14 instead of $12. (b) You are the Haggler: the advice says $6, but $7 wins. (c) Two

buyers of the same fruit each get "At $5 you'd have sold 2" from a crate of 2. (d) You sold your only mango to a later buyer at $10, but the advice tells you to cut to $6 for an earlier one. (e) Both stalls played Favoured Trade: the game says "Rosa bought earlier today" when you did; Rosa actually won as the Haggler.

- **Fix (package A).** The after-sale advice follows the real tie order (Favoured Trade, Haggler, fresher fruit, earlier buyer) and the size of your crate: "At $6 you'd have sold 2. A tie at $7 still loses: Rosa is the Haggler, who wins ties." / "Matching $7 would have won the tie (your fruit was fresher): 2 sold." / "You still sold all 1 at your price." Presentation only.
- **Before the bell.** The pre-filled price comes from the computer planner, which treats a tie as a shared sale. In 360 test setups against Rosa it pre-filled her exact price in 262, and in 26 of them $1 less would have sold more and earned more. Package A adds a hint for people only ("Rosa wins ties"). Teaching the computer players the real tie order is package B (balance).

3.7 Scout shown as Gossip, and "unripe $1 now"

- **Scout.** After Scout, the walk-in card shows the ear badge "You heard about this walk-in (Gossip)". Both favours write the same mark on the card and leave no trace of which one it was, so the game cannot tell them apart. Only people see this: computer players never play Scout. **Fix (package A):** one neutral line, "You've seen this walk-in's card". Separate Scout and Gossip labels would need a new field in the engine and the online view (a small plan of its own).
- **"$1 now".** The set-up switch says "Some deliveries arrive unripe: $1 now, sell later. Mangoes take longest." That was true when the game began (every green fruit cost $1). Since rules 9, only mangoes arrive green (Mango Growers and Mango Season) and they cost 4(5 on a Price Hike day). **Fix (package A):** build the sentence from the game data: "Some lorries bring mangoes green: from $4, ready to sell after 2 nights."
- **Green watermelon.** The rulebook, the data and How to play still describe a green watermelon (1 night, $1), but no lorry delivers one any more. The market still draws its empty slot with a $1 price and the lorry marker on every screen, which probably made the $1 look real. **Fix (package A, as assumed in section 1):** retire it in RULES.md and How to play, and hide green cells on the market for fruit no lorry delivers green. Removing the slot from the engine would change saves and online play and needs its own plan; it is not proposed.

4. Packages

Package	What	Needs
A · Wording and explanations	Items 1 (text and sales card), 2, 3, 4, 6 (after-sale advice and a tie hint for people), 7, with a test for each case above	Your yes. No rules change, no RULES_VERSION bump, saves and online unchanged. Touches story text in `src/engine/story.ts`, an optional juice counter in the player's stats, the game panels, RULES.md, How to play and GAME-BRIEF wording. About one session plus the full test run.
B · Computer players	Leftovers worth $1 on Closing Day (pricing and buying); the real tie order when they plan prices	Your yes, then a balance run (Normal and Hard, shopkeeper win rates within about 3 points of fair) before release
C · Juice Bar rule	Only if you choose option A or B in item 5	Rules version 10, rules and card text, a balance run

Package	What	Needs
Later	The anonymous counter `fruit_unsold` records jam dollars, not unsold fruit	A plan, because it is data handling

Package A goes in after the Phone A layout work, because both change the same game screens.

5. Validation

Check	Result
Each report reproduced on the real engine with a script	PASS (all seven)
Second, independent check of every finding	PASS (all agreed or partly agreed; corrections are folded into section 3)
Game code changed	NOT APPLICABLE (investigation only)
`npm run verify` for this report	NOT RUN (no code changed; `npm run records:check` covers the report)

6. Risks and costs

- Cost RM0. Package A is low risk; the main risk is wording that still misleads, which the tests above guard against.
- Package B makes the computer players slightly stronger on the final day; the balance run is there to catch it.
- Juice Bar option A weakens an upgrade that is already weak (REP-086).
- The game screens are being changed by the Phone A layout work right now; package A waits for it to land, so the two do not clash.